

Cassowary



Cassowaries lay huge, green eggs. Unlike many different birds, the males look after them.

It's easy to remember that birds evolved from dinosaurs when you spot the prehistoric-looking cassowary. This big bird is the second heaviest on Earth after the ostrich, and like the ostrich it can't fly. The cassowary is a shy animal that wanders about alone through its rainforest home. However, it can be dangerous when defending itself. Powerful legs and sharp talons 10 cm (4 in) long can deliver a deadly kick.

Cassowaries have a tough helmet on the top of their head called a casque (ca-sk). Could this help the bird to hear? Does it show other cassowaries who's stronger? Perhaps it is for barging through the thick foliage of the forest. No one knows!